

Ilya Fedorov

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Summary:

- Head of Engineering with 20+ years of experience across software development, system design, and organisational leadership in high-growth and mission-driven environments.
- Proven track record of building high-performing engineering teams, establishing scalable delivery systems, and aligning technology execution with business strategy.
- Experienced at operating at senior leadership and board level, improving delivery predictability, and driving alignment across Engineering, Product, Operations, and Customer Success.
- Focused on designing effective operating models, reducing ambiguity, and enabling teams to deliver consistently under pressure. Combines deep technical expertise with pragmatic leadership to balance short-term delivery with long-term scalability and resilience.

Recent experience:

Mindhive

- **Head of Engineering - Feb 2025 – Present**

AI/ML company delivering industrial computer vision solutions for automated grading, defect detection, and operational workflows.

- Lead engineering across software, platform, and ML delivery in a globally distributed startup (NZ, Brazil, Europe).
- Established engineering leadership structure, improving alignment, accountability, and team effectiveness.
- Designed and implemented a new delivery cadence to improve predictability and reduce disruption from reactive demand.
- Introduced structured intake, triage, and prioritisation across Engineering, Product, and Customer Success.
- Implemented engineering flow metrics, improving visibility of demand, delivery performance, and system constraints.
- Supported shift toward a more productised and scalable operating model.
- Contributed to SLT and board discussions on capacity, prioritisation, security posture, and organisational design.
- Strengthened platform operations and follow-the-sun support capability, improving resilience.
- Accelerated adoption of AI-assisted engineering practices to improve delivery effectiveness.

Tradify

- **Senior Software Engineering Manager | Dec 2023 – Feb 2025**

High-growth SaaS platform for trades businesses, scaling rapidly across international markets.

- Led multiple engineering teams, aligning delivery with product strategy and scaling objectives.
- Initiated and delivered frontend modernisation (AngularJS → React) with a zero-downtime migration approach.
- Introduced flow metrics across engineering and product, enabling data-driven delivery decisions.
- Identified and resolved systemic platform misuse, reducing spamming incidents by ~75%.
- Established structured initiatives to reduce technical debt and improve system health.
- Transitioned performance management to continuous feedback, improving engagement and development.
- Strengthened engineering culture, increasing psychological safety and team effectiveness.
- Acted as a key interface between engineering and senior leadership.

Te Kete Hono

- **Dec 2023 - October 2024 - Advisor to the board**
- **March 2021- Dec 2023 - Head of Software Engineering**
- **May 2020 - March 2021 - Technology partner**

Social impact ed-tech organisation delivering SaaS products to 20,000+ users across the education sector.

- Defined and executed technology strategy and multi-year roadmap across a SaaS product portfolio.
- Built and led a high-performing engineering team, establishing a culture of ownership and continuous improvement.
- Introduced governance and development standards, improving quality and scalability.

- Led transition to microservices architecture, improving performance (~30% avg, ~75% peak).
- Delivered cloud migration and infrastructure modernisation, reducing costs by ~50%.
- Implemented secure development lifecycle practices; achieved 100% compliance in external audit.
- Improved delivery predictability and time-to-market across key initiatives.
- Partnered closely with executives and Board on strategic and operational decisions.
- Established data privacy and security frameworks supporting 20,000+ users.

Serko

- **Aug 2019 – Apr 2020 – Software engineering manager**

Market-leading corporate travel and expense platform across NZ and Australia.

- Built and led a high-performing engineering team.
- Improved delivery capability through modern engineering practices and stronger feedback loops.
- Reduced error rates on critical pathways by ~90%.
- Supported transition from startup to scale-up, aligning teams with product and business goals.
- Contributed to platform stabilisation and early AI capability development.

Propellerhead.

- **Product Owner / Development Manager | Oct 2017 – Nov 2019**

Digital consultancy delivering complex software solutions across government, commercial, and startup clients.

- Led multi-stream delivery across several client engagements in dynamic, resource-constrained environments.
- Directed distributed teams and coordinated 10+ third-party vendors.
- Translated complex stakeholder needs into structured delivery plans and roadmaps.
- Oversaw end-to-end delivery from discovery through to implementation.
- Defined architecture and guided technical direction across multiple projects.

- Improved delivery quality through stronger engineering practices and standards.

Selected projects:

- Identity migration across 10 corporate websites
- MVP delivery for NZ-based AML startup
- Professional learning platform
- Video streaming prototype for major NZ sports organisation
- CMS implementation (Silverstripe)

Schooltalk

- **Co-founder / Software Engineering Manager | Jan 2015 – Sept 2017**

Social impact ed-tech startup improving teaching and student outcomes.

- Co-founded and built a SaaS platform from concept to production.
- Led product strategy, architecture, and engineering delivery.
- Worked closely with educators to validate and shape product direction.
- Built and led engineering capability, introducing agile practices.
- Secured funding through grants and stakeholder engagement.
- Delivered measurable improvements in teaching practices and student outcomes.

Previous experience

- 2013 - 2014 Senior Full Stack Software Developer at Freedom.com
- 2007 - 2013 Senior Analyst / Programmer at Freightways
- 2006 - 2007 Senior Analyst / Programmer at Thor United
- 2001 - 2005 Analyst / Programmer at Sportmaster.com

Professional Development:

- Executive Coaching: Noah Cantor (2024–present), Paul Birch (2025–present)

Leadership & Community

- Founded and facilitate a peer forum of engineering leaders (Canva, Gentrack, Fintfox) focused on scaling teams, delivery systems, and leadership effectiveness
- Mentor at University of Auckland Chiasma programme
- Chair, local VEX V5 robotics club supporting homeschooled students in competitive robotics (2026)

Education:

- Postgraduate Diploma in Information Technology and Computer Science (Auckland University of Technology)
- Postgraduate Diploma in Business Analysis (Russian Academy of National Economy)
- Master of Applied Physics and Mathematics (Moscow Institute of Physics and Technology)